Alexander the Great and the Rise of Rome

Alexander the Great is known as one of the world's best military leaders of all time. Born in 356 BCE, he was inspired by Phillip's dreams of overthrowing Persia in revenge for attempting to invade Greece decades earlier. When Alexander took his father's throne, he assembled his mighty army, which consisted of nearly the entire country's men. With the necessary funds, he first travelled to Egypt, then swept through Asia Minor into Persia, and eventually landed in India. Alexander had studied under the great philosopher Aristotle, who had in turn been taught by Plato. As a result of Alexander's travel, Greek philosophy and language quickly spread across the classical world of his time.

In 323 BCE, Alexander the Great died and left the territory he once held to be divided among four of his greatest generals. This period is known as the Hellenistic era (323 – 31 BCE) during which Greek beliefs and ideas reached their pinnacle. The generals were known as the Diodachi and for a time there were numerous power struggles that occurred between them. Antigonus founded the Antigonid Dynasty in Greece but quickly fell from power before being restored by his grandson Antigonus II Gonatus.

It was at this time that Rome began taking an interest in the Greek world. In 168 BCE, the Roman Empire met the Greek army at Pydna where they defeated them. As a result, Greece became influenced by Rome and in 146 BCE, Greece was proclaimed a Protectorate of Rome. The Romans heavily borrowed from Greek culture and society by adopting their religion, mythology, language, and philosophy. After Octavian defeated Queen Cleopatra of Egypt and Mark Anthony at the Battle of Actium in 31 BCE, Octavian renamed his Emperor Augustus and Greece was incorporated into the Roman Empire.